

# HomeQuote AI Canada — Build & Launch Plan

*Vibe-coding the contractor-quote decision room, built for a once-a-decade customer*

Prepared August 2026. Companion to the BillShield plan — same stack, method, and founder rhythm; this covers what's different. Rated 16/25 (lowest of the five): the easiest sale on the list — \$49 against a \$40,000 decision — attached to the worst usage frequency (people renovate every 5–10 years) in a category crowding fast. The plan accepts the frequency problem and designs the whole business around surviving it.

## 0. What we're building, in one paragraph

A homeowner uploads two or three contractor quotes for the same renovation. The product normalizes them into one honest comparison table — what each quote actually *includes* — then flags the risk patterns: vague allowances, missing scope (who pays for disposal? permits?), oversized deposits, absent warranty language, change-order traps, and payment schedules that front-load risk onto the homeowner. It ends with the exact questions to ask each contractor. The customer is about to sign the biggest cheque of their year; \$49 for clarity is the easiest yes across all five ideas. The hard part is that they won't need you again for years — so the model is transactional revenue plus a **Renovation Decision Room** that keeps them for the 3–12 month project, and an acquisition engine built on referral partners who face this question weekly even though each homeowner faces it rarely.

### Scope discipline:

| Build now                                                                   | Build later (month 4+)                                                                      | Never                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Multi-quote upload → normalized comparison table                            | Renovation Decision Room: change-order log, payment tracker, receipt vault, progress photos | Recommending specific contractors (destroys neutrality — neutrality <i>is</i> the product)                              |
| Red-flag engine (allowances, deposits, scope gaps, warranty, payment terms) | Milestone payment-schedule generator                                                        | Contractor marketplace / lead-gen (two-sided trap, and a conflict of interest)                                          |
| Question-arsenal per contractor                                             | Ontario consumer-protection info layer (cooling-off, deposit norms — cited, not advised)    | Estimating what a renovation <i>should</i> cost from scratch (you're auditing quotes, not replacing quantity surveyors) |
| One-off Stripe checkout: \$49/project (covers up to 3 quotes)               | Second project type packs (roofing, windows, bathroom, kitchen)                             | Legal or engineering advice of any kind                                                                                 |

## 1. The build plan — what's different from BillShield

**Same foundation, same reused extraction engine** — contractor quotes are the messiest documents in the whole portfolio (Word docs, photographed napkin math, 14-page PDFs), which is exactly why normalizing them is worth \$49.

**1. The scope taxonomy is the product.** Build a canonical checklist per project type — demolition, structural, electrical, plumbing, fixtures, finishes, disposal, permits, cleanup, warranty, payment terms — starting with the two highest-volume types only (kitchens and bathrooms). Every quote gets mapped against the taxonomy: *included / excluded / allowance / unclear*. "Unclear" is the money finding — it's the word that starts the right conversation with the contractor. Resist project-type breadth until the engine is excellent on two.

**2. The red-flag library is curated judgment, encoded.** Deposit size vs. Ontario norms, allowance vagueness ("\$4,000 fixtures allowance" with no spec), missing change-order process, no lien-holdback awareness, payment schedules ahead of work completed. Each flag carries plain-language "why this matters" text reviewed once by a construction-savvy advisor (find one — a retired PM or estimator will review your library for a few hundred dollars and their name adds instant credibility).

**3. Eval suite: 25 real quote sets.** Harder to collect than bills — source from renovation Facebook groups, family, and by offering *free audits during validation* (every free audit is both training data and a testimonial). Gate releases on extraction + taxonomy-mapping accuracy, same discipline as every other product in the portfolio.

2. Timeline — 12 weeks, revenue by week 8, spring surge as the real launch

Renovation demand peaks March–June. A fall/winter build hits the market exactly when planning season starts (people plan in February, sign in April).

| Phase                 | Weeks      | Deliverable                                                                | Definition of done                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Validate              | 0–1        | "Send us your renovation quotes, get a free comparison" concierge offer    | 15 real quote sets audited <i>manually</i> (founders do it by hand, AI-assisted). This validates willingness-to-pay AND builds the eval suite simultaneously — the manual audits are the spec. |
| Extraction + taxonomy | 2–5        | Upload → normalized comparison table (kitchens + bathrooms)                | ≥85% correct inclusion/exclusion mapping on the eval suite (quotes are messier than bills; 85% + human-review flag beats fake 95%).                                                            |
| Red-flag engine       | 6–7        | Flags + question arsenal + advisor-reviewed language                       | A homeowner reads the report and books follow-up conversations with contractors — measured in beta.                                                                                            |
| Monetize              | 8          | Stripe one-off: \$49/project; free tier = 1 quote, basic table             | <b>First paying customer.</b> Free-to-paid instrumented from day one.                                                                                                                          |
| Polish + PDF          | 9–10       | Beautiful, shareable report (spouses and co-signers are the second reader) | ≥8/10 "would recommend to a friend renovating."                                                                                                                                                |
| Launch                | 11–12      | SEO base + partner outreach begins                                         | 25 cost/red-flag pages live; 3 referral partners sending traffic.                                                                                                                              |
| Decision Room         | Months 4–6 | Change-order log, payment tracker, vault (\$9.99/mo during active project) | Build only if ≥30% of report buyers say they want ongoing tracking — otherwise stay transactional and cheap to run.                                                                            |

**Milestone math:** \$4,000/month  $\approx$  82 reports  $\approx$  ~3/day — the *lowest* volume requirement of the five ideas, which partially offsets the frequency problem. Realistic: 20/month by month 5 through partners + early SEO, the \$4K line by month 9–12 riding the spring surge.

### 3. Marketing — partners who face the question weekly, plus renovation-cost SEO

**Positioning:** *"Before you sign for \$40,000, know what's actually in the quote."* Neutral auditor, contractor-friendly in tone — good contractors *benefit* when vague competitors get exposed, and some will voluntarily send clients ("get it audited, mine will hold up").

- **Channel 1 — Referral partners (the frequency fix).** The homeowner renovates once a decade, but realtors, home inspectors, mortgage brokers, and interior designers get asked "is this quote reasonable?" *every week*. A neutral \$49 tool is an easy hand-off that makes them look good, with no conflict. Ten warm partners producing 2 referrals/week  $\approx$  the entire month-5 target. This is founder-B's primary outbound motion from week 10.
- **Channel 2 — Renovation-cost SEO.** "Kitchen renovation cost Ontario 2027," "contractor deposit rules Ontario," "renovation quote red flags," "what should a bathroom reno include" — high-intent, Canada-specific, weakly served. 2 pages/week; every page embeds a "paste one quote, see the analysis" free taste.
- **Channel 3 — Facebook renovation and homeowner groups.** This demographic lives in local Facebook groups, not TikTok. Months of genuinely useful presence ("here's what an 'allowance' means and why it bites people"), then the free single-quote tool. Same never-astroturf rule as every other channel.
- **Channel 4 — Red-flag content as short-form/press.** Anonymized real-quote teardowns ("this \$46K quote has no demolition line — someone's paying for that later") work as Reels and as pitchable consumer-protection stories; renovation-nightmare coverage is a perennial Canadian media beat.

### 4. Metrics, targets, and kill criteria

| Metric                                          | Target                                                    | Why                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Concierge validation conversions (weeks 0–1)    | $\geq$ 5 of 15 free-audit users say they'd have paid \$49 | Cheapest possible test of the entire thesis, before real code.      |
| Free single-quote → paid full-report conversion | $\geq$ 10%                                                | Intent is white-hot; below this the report isn't proving its value. |
| Paid reports/month                              | 20 by month 5; 82 (the \$4K line) by month 9–12           | The honest volume path.                                             |
| Active referral partners                        | 10 by month 6                                             | The channel that defeats the frequency problem.                     |
| "Would recommend" score                         | $\geq$ 8/10                                               | Each customer disappears for years — their referral is their LTV.   |

**Kill / pivot criteria:** if the week-0 concierge test can't find 5 willing payers among 15 free audits, stop before building — that's the whole point of testing it manually first. Post-launch: under 60 total paid reports by month 6, or

partners refusing to refer (the tell that neutrality/quality isn't landing) → fold the taxonomy and red-flag library into content, keep the SEO asset, and redeploy. **Standing competitive check:** this category is crowding (QuoteGuard et al.); if a funded player owns "renovation quote audit" search intent before you do, partners become the only channel — reassess honestly at that point.

*One-sentence version: validate with 15 hand-done audits before writing real code, charge \$49 from week 8, solve the once-a-decade customer problem with partners who face the question weekly, and let the pre-agreed concierge test — not sunk cost — decide if this one gets built at all.*